

Rahul Yedida

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EDUCATION

North Carolina State University

Ph.D. Computer Science

Raleigh, NC

Aug 2019 - Jul 2024

- Advisor: *Dr. Tim Menzies*

- Dissertation: [Guidelines for the Application of Neural Technologies in Software Analytics \(or: How to Do More with Less in SE\)](#)

PES University

B.E. Computer Science – Advisor: Dr. Snehanshu Saha

Bangalore, India

Aug 2015 - May 2019

EMPLOYMENT

LexisNexis Legal & Professional

Senior Data Scientist I

Raleigh, NC

May 2024 - Present

- Reduced customer-facing product runtime by 24.8% and cut time spent at peak memory from 86.4% to 68% of the runtime via lazy module loading, LLM call profiling, and parallelization.
- As part of a 3-person team, improved complaint drafting usefulness from 40% to 86% and motion drafting from 59.2% to 76%.
- Led the migration from RAG to an agentic legal drafting system as tech lead, and own its continued development.
- Developed a fast (median 12ms) passage filtering approach based on contrastive loss.
- Built team developer tooling: a Rust MITM proxy with request replay, a web UI for visualizing intermediate agent steps, and custom Python lint rules beyond `ruff`'s rule set.
- Mentored an intern on a large-scale, full factorial experiment investigating Pareto-optimal configurations for draft quality and latency.
- **Technology:** Python, Litestar, Google ADK, React, Rust, TypeScript, Tailwind

North Carolina State University

PhD Student

Raleigh, NC

Aug 2019 - Jul 2024

- **State-of-the-art hyper-parameter optimization:** Proposed a novel hyper-parameter optimization method that outperforms prior SOTA and is 36.4% faster.
- **Better, faster deep learning for SE:** Improved defect prediction by up to 123% (F-1 score), code smell detection by up to 30% (AUC), issue lifetime prediction by up to 76% (accuracy), automated microservice partitioning by up to 285% (modularity) compared to prior SOTA.
- **Semi-supervised learning:** Achieved state-of-the-art results (up to 100% improvement in AUC) on static code warnings analysis using 10% of the labels.
- **Teaching:** TA for 830 students over 5 semesters across CSC 230 (C and Software Tools), CSC 510 (Software Engineering), and CSC 591/791 (Automated Software Engineering)

Amazon

Software Dev Engineer Intern

New York, NY / Bellevue, WA

May 2023 - Aug 2023

- Implemented and shipped profile locks for Prime Video on Echo Show devices.
- **Technology:** React Native, TypeScript

Software Dev Engineer Intern

May 2022 - Jul 2022

- Developed a full-stack system to publish announcements in scorecards used by delivery service partners.
- **Technology:** React/Redux, TypeScript, Redux Saga, DynamoDB, Java Spring

RECENT PUBLICATIONS

See full list on [Google Scholar](#).

1. **Yedida, R.**, & Menzies, T. (2025). Is Hyper-Parameter Optimization Different for Software Analytics? *IEEE Transactions on Software Engineering*, 51(6).
2. Baldassarre, M. T., Ernst, N., Hermann, B., Menzies, T., & **Yedida, R.** (2023). (Re)use of Research Results (is Rampant). *Communications of the ACM*, 66(2), 75-81.
3. **Yedida, R.**, Kang, H. J., Tu, K., Lo, D., & Menzies, T. (2023). How to Find Actionable Static Analysis Warnings: A Case Study with FindBugs. *IEEE Transactions on Software Engineering*, 49(4), 2856-2872.

4. **Yedida, R.**, Krishna, R., Kalia, A., Menzies, T., Xiao, J., & Vukovic, M. (2023). An Expert System for Redesigning Software for Cloud Applications. *Expert Systems with Applications*, 219, 119673.
5. **Yedida, R.**, Menzies, T. (2022). How to Improve Deep Learning for Software Analytics (a case study with code smell detection). In *2022 IEEE/ACM 19th International Conference on Mining Software Repositories (MSR)*.
6. **Yedida, R.**, & Menzies, T. (2021). On the Value of Oversampling for Deep Learning in Software Defect Prediction. *IEEE Transactions on Software Engineering*, 48(8), 3103-3116.
7. Agrawal, A., Yang, X., Agrawal, R., **Yedida, R.**, Shen, X., & Menzies, T. (2021). Simpler Hyperparameter Optimization for Software Analytics: Why, How, When?. *IEEE Transactions on Software Engineering*, 48(8), 2939-2954.
8. Yang, X., Chen, J., **Yedida, R.**, Yu, Z., & Menzies, T. (2021). Learning to recognize actionable static code warnings (is intrinsically easy). *Empirical Software Engineering*, 26(3), 1-24.
9. **Yedida, R.**, Krishna, R., Kalia, A., Menzies, T., Xiao, J., & Vukovic, M. (2021). Lessons learned from hyper-parameter tuning for microservice candidate identification. *Proceedings of the thirty-sixth IEEE/ACM International Conference on Automated Software Engineering (ASE)*.
10. **Yedida, R.**, & Saha, S. (2021). Beginning with Machine Learning: A Comprehensive Primer. *The European Physical Journal Special Topics*, 230(10), 2363-2444.
11. Saha, S., Nagaraj, N., Mathur, A., **Yedida, R.**, & Sneha, H. R. (2020). Evolution of novel activation functions in neural network training for astronomy data: habitability classification of exoplanets. *The European Physical Journal Special Topics*, 229(16), 2629-2738.
12. **Yedida, R.**, Saha, S., & Prashanth, T. (2020). LipschitzLR: Using theoretically computed adaptive learning rates for fast convergence. *Applied Intelligence*, 1-19.
13. Sridhar, S., Saha, S., Shaikh, A., **Yedida, R.**, & Saha, S. (2020, July). Parsimonious Computing: A Minority Training Regime for Effective Prediction in Large Microarray Expression Data Sets. In *2020 International Joint Conference on Neural Networks (IJCNN)* (pp. 1-8).
14. Khaidem, L., **Yedida, R.**, & Theophilus, A. J. (2019, November). Optimizing Inter-nationality of Journals: A Classical Gradient Approach Revisited via Swarm Intelligence. In *International Conference on Modeling, Machine Learning and Astronomy* (pp. 3-14). *Springer, Singapore*.

PREPRINTS

1. Hearn, T., Evans, W., **Yedida, R.**, Abdelshiheed, M., Rebei, A., & Khazaeli, S. (2025). Automated Legal Brief Drafting via Iterative Retrieval-Augmented Generation.
2. Rashid, P., Pal, S., Samudrala, V. K., **Yedida, R.**, & Gehringer, E. (2025). Enhancing Peer Assessment Reliability: A Probabilistic Approach Integrating Formative and Summative Feedback.
3. Mehendale, S., Challa, A., **Yedida, R.**, Danda, S., Sarkar, S., & Saha, S. (2025). Radon–Nikodym Derivative: Re-imagining Anomaly Detection from a Measure Theoretic Perspective.
4. **Yedida, R.**, & Saha, S. (2024). Strong convexity-guided hyper-parameter optimization for flatter losses.

FUNDING

\$5,000, Google Cloud Academic Research Grant, Feb 2022

SERVICE TO PROFESSION

Contributing Member, Python Software Foundation (Mar 2021 - Present)

Guest Editor, IEEE Software SI: The Impact of AI on Productivity and Code 2025; ASEj SI: Replications and Negative Results (RENE) 2025; EMSE SI: Replications and Negative Results (RENE) 2025

Workshop Co-Chair, Intelligent Software Engineering (ASE '25, ICST '26); Replications and Negative Results (ASE '24)

PC Member, AAAI 2025-2027; FSE 2026-2027; ICSE 2026-2027; EDM 2026; ASE Industry Track 2026; AI Foundation Models and Software Engineering (FORGE) 2024; ICSME Artifact Evaluation Track, 2021-2023; ASE Artifact Evaluation Track, 2022; International Conference on Modeling, Machine Learning, and Astronomy (MMLA), 2019

Reviewer, TOSEM 2026; TSE 2025-2026; NeurIPS 2023, 2025; EMSE 2021, 2025; ASEj 2025; ICML 2024-2025; ICLR 2024-2025; NCAA 2023-2025; TMLR 2024; Neural Processing Letters 2023-2024; Artificial Intelligence Review 2023; J. Big Data, 2023; ASE 2023; IEEE SSCI 2020

HONORS

Distinguished Reviewer, ICSE 2026	Mar 2026
Google Developer Expert - ML and GCP	Mar 2025 - Present
A global network of experts recognized by Google for deep technical expertise, community leadership, and mentorship.	
Google Cloud Champion Innovator - Cloud AI/ML	Oct 2022 - Mar 2025
A Googler-nominated global network of 500+ technical experts in Google Cloud; merged into the Google Developer Experts program in 2025.	
Google Cloud Research Innovator	Feb 2022
Research Innovators are a global community of researchers driving scientific breakthroughs with Google Cloud.	

INVITED TALKS

Feb 2024, “*Improving deep learning performance using theoretical ML*” at BITS Pilani, KK Birla Goa Campus, India

RELEVANT PROJECTS

Q&A System for Zotero <i>Rust, SQLite, LanceDB</i>	Oct 2024 - Present GitHub :: crates.io
Built an academic question-answering and semantic search system over a user's Zotero library. Wrote a custom PDF parser for academic papers (1,900 pages/s over 330 papers; M4 Pro) and a RAG library with support for multiple providers and tool calling.	
JournalBear <i>JavaScript, Electron, SwiftUI</i>	Jan 2017 - Jul 2026 GitHub :: App Store :: Softpedia
Cross-platform journaling app with AES-256 encryption and separate native apps for iOS and macOS. Rated 4/5 by Softpedia.	
The 1 Billion Row Challenge (1BRC) <i>Zig</i>	Feb 2026 - Apr 2026 GitHub
Wrote a Zig implementation for the 1BRC, running in 1.20s (M4 Pro, 14 core) using mmap, open addressing (Wyhash + Robin Hood probing), and packed SIMD.	
RAISE <i>Python, Keras</i>	Aug 2020 - Jun 2025 GitHub :: PyPI
Sole developer of an ML utilities Python package used by multiple research groups for reproducible experiments. Downloaded 65k times on PyPI.	
Programmable Resumes <i>Python</i>	Aug 2023 - Mar 2025 GitHub
Developed a specification and implementation for modular, customizable resumes with support for two popular LaTeX templates. Wrote this resume using this tool.	
pysh <i>C++, TMLanguage</i>	May 2021 - Dec 2024 GitHub
Developed a superset of Python that allows running shell code natively, with a VS Code syntax highlighting extension.	
Threaded Discussions Website <i>MongoDB, Node.js, React</i>	Feb 2021 - Jun 2021 GitHub
Built a companion site for video calls supporting Reddit-style threaded discussions.	
Google/Meta Data Mining <i>Python, Keras</i>	Feb 2021 - May 2021 GitHub
Mined Google Takeout and Meta data exports to predict which Amazon best-sellers to advertise to a user (DistilGPT-2, 0.6 F-1 score).	
NearConnect <i>iOS, SwiftUI</i>	Nov 2020 - Mar 2021 GitHub :: App Store
iOS app to connect with people nearby using multicast peer-to-peer connections.	
Novel Drug Repurposing Hypotheses <i>Python, PyTorch</i>	Oct 2019 - Feb 2020 GitHub
Identified novel drug repurposing hypotheses by text mining transcripts of an NPR medical radio show, and verified results using a knowledge graph.	

Personalized Chatbot <i>Python, Keras</i> Fine-tuned a GPT-2 345M model on 730k messages from Telegram logs to create a personalized chatbot.	May 2019 - May 2019 GitHub
Intelligent Tutoring System <i>Python</i> Implemented an Intelligent Tutoring System backend using Bayesian Knowledge Tracing and a novel question selection algorithm.	Sep 2018 - May 2019 GitHub
Astronomy Image Restoration <i>Python, Keras</i> Developed a machine learning approach to restore astronomical images affected by PSF anisotropy and smearing in crowded-field photometry. Improved data retention and accuracy in differential imaging analysis of long-baseline optical time series.	Aug 2018 - Nov 2018 GitHub
Human Activity Data Project <i>Python, Keras</i> Collected personal activity data for 9 months, grouped tasks into 21 categories. Analyzed most productive hours of the day.	Oct 2018 - Nov 2018 GitHub
Results Scraper <i>MongoDB, Express.js, React, Node.js</i> Website for scraping university examination results and displaying charts and printable reports, with caching.	Mar 2018 - Aug 2018 GitHub
Video Sharing Website <i>MySQL, Express.js, React, Node.js, Sass, Elasticsearch</i> Simplified implementation of a video-sharing website with subscriptions and custom searching.	Oct 2017 - Dec 2017 GitHub
Web development projects <i>MongoDB, Express.js, React, Node.js, Sass, D3.js</i> Projects include URL shortener, rogue-like dungeon crawler game, voting application, Simon game, land surface temperature heatmap, and mapping meteorite impacts across the globe.	Jan 2017 - Nov 2017 CodePen
Xtreme Calculations <i>VB.NET, Python</i> Windows math software to solve scientific and mathematical problems, with over 30k downloads across multiple sites.	Apr 2013 - Oct 2017 Softpedia
Video Indexer <i>C++, Qt, Sphinx</i> Cross-platform desktop application to detect the time(s) a given keyword was spoken in a video.	Jun 2017 - Sep 2017 GitHub

SKILLS

Languages: Rust, Python, TypeScript, Java, C++, Gleam

ML/AI: Keras, PyTorch, Hyper-parameter optimization

Frameworks: React, Flask, Litestar, FastAPI

Databases: LanceDB, MySQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB

Cloud: Google Cloud (Compute Engine, Cloud Storage, Vertex AI), AWS (EC2, S3, DynamoDB)